



Google Lens

Here are some handy tips and tricks for Google's AR-powered photo-recognition tool

Dhriti Datta |
dhriti@digit.in

GOOGLE LENS IS AN EXTREMELY UNDERRATED APP that essentially works as a bridge between the physical world around you and the virtual world on your device. The app has been functional for quite some time now, however, not many people use it extensively. Essentially, the app emulates the Google search engine, but for the real world instead. Leveraging the power of AR and

AI, it is a photo-recognition tool that can identify objects and text via the viewfinder in the app and even through already existing images on your device. Users can glean information about the object they're looking at. For example, say you were out in a foreign country and you visit a monument that you want to learn more about. Instead of paying your hard-earned money to the tourist guides around in the area, you can simply whip up your phone, turn on Google Lens and capture the scene to find out all kinds of information about the site. Or if you've come across a gorgeous flower when trekking, fire up Google Lens and it will provide you with a wealth of information about the particular flower you're

looking at. The app can do all kinds of utilitarian things as well that aren't well-known. So, let's look at some useful tips and tricks that will help you get the most out of Google Lens.



COPY TEXT FROM THE VIEWFINDER

One of Google Lens's most powerful features is the ability to grab text from a physical document such as a paper, book, whiteboard, or anything with words on it, and bring it onto your phone's clipboard. From here you can paste the text that you have selected from the viewfinder into notes, email, chat apps, and more. All you need to do is fire up Google Lens, point your camera at the text and click the shutter button. Google Lens will then highlight all the text in the document. You can then select an exact portion of the text, as you would on a website. Next, you just have to hit the 'Copy' button and the text will now be on your clipboard, ready to be pasted wherever you desire.

From here, you can also copy the selected text to your computer, which is pretty useful since most of us don't work on our smartphones. After selecting the

text, instead of just hitting 'Copy' as we did before, select 'Copy to computer' in the panel at the bottom of the screen. You'll now be able to choose from a list of computers where you are actively logged into Chrome with the same account as on your phone, be it Windows, Mac, Linux, or Chrome OS. Pick the PC you want and the text will get copied on your computer's clipboard. Now, you can just Ctrl + V (Cmd + V on Mac) the text anywhere you'd like.



HAVE TEXT FROM THE REAL WORLD BE READ OUT LOUD

If you've just been handed out a long pamphlet or note for you to read, you can actually make Google Lens read it out for you. Just fire up Google Lens and point your phone's camera at the paper. Click the shutter button and now tap the 'Listen' button on the panel at the bottom of the screen. Google will then read the text you've highlighted out loud for you.



GRAB TEXT FROM SCREENSHOTTED IMAGES

In addition to interacting with text from the real-

